

1337

THE HUNDRED YEARS' WAR BEGINS

In 1337, Edward III, the king of England, asserted a hereditary claim to the French throne. This action started a war that lasted intermittently for 116 years. The English took the offensive, scoring victories in a naval battle at Sluys in 1340 and on land at Crécy in 1346. The French knights had no answer to England's longbowmen, but French fortunes revived under King Charles V from 1364.



△ English coin celebrating the victory at Sluys



△ The battle of Crécy, fought in France in 1346

1330

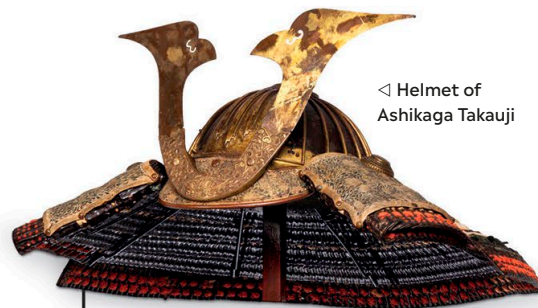


△ Miniature from the *Shahnameh*

1335

PERSIA'S MOST BEAUTIFUL BOOK

The illustrated version of the Persian epic poem the *Shahnameh* produced at Tabriz in the 1330s was among the highest achievements of Persian miniature painting. Produced for the country's Mongol Ilkhan rulers, it is known as the Great Mongol *Shahnameh*.



△ Helmet of Ashikaga Takauji

1338

ASHIKAGA SHOGUNATE

Under the Kamakura shogunate established in 1185, the Japanese emperor was a powerless figurehead. In 1333, Emperor Go-Daigo called for the restoration of imperial rule. Samurai Ashikaga Takauji led the overthrow of the shogunate on Go-Daigo's behalf, but soon became disillusioned with the emperor. In 1338, Ashikaga seized power for himself, founding a shogunate that lasted for two centuries.

1347 The Black Death is first reported in the West in Crimea

